

Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-07-05

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Psalm 109:17-31

17 As he loved cursing, so let it come to him; As he did not delight in blessing, so let it be far from him.

18 As he clothed himself with cursing as with his garment, So let it enter his body like water, And like oil into his bones.

19 Let it be to him like the garment which covers him, And for a belt with which he girds himself continually.

20 Let this be the Lord's reward to my accusers, And to those who speak evil against my person.

21 But You, O God the Lord, Deal with me for Your name's sake; Because Your mercy is good, deliver me.

22 For I am poor and needy, And my heart is wounded within me.

23 I am gone like a shadow when it lengthens; I am shaken off like a locust.

24 My knees are weak through fasting, And my flesh is feeble from lack of fatness.

25 I also have become a reproach to them; When they look at me, they shake their heads.

26 Help me, O Lord my God! Oh, save me according to Your mercy,

27 That they may know that this is Your hand— That You, Lord, have done it!

28 Let them curse, but You bless; When they arise, let them be ashamed, But let Your servant rejoice.

29 Let my accusers be clothed with shame, And let them cover themselves with their own disgrace as with a mantle.

30 I will greatly praise the Lord with my mouth; Yes, I will praise Him among the multitude.

31 For He shall stand at the right hand of the poor, To save him from those who condemn him.

II. Key Summary

- Verses 17–20 continue the previous section, saying that the man who loved cursing has cursing come upon himself; this is the reward the Lord gives to those who accuse and speak evil against David.
 - In vv. 21–25 David turns to plead with God, saying he is poor and needy, wounded in heart, and weak in body from fasting, and asks God to deliver him according to His mercy.
 - In vv. 30–31 David says he will greatly praise God among the multitude, because God stands at the right hand of the poor to save him from those who condemn him.
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III. Passage Analysis

Topic 1: We Come to God on the Basis of His Mercy

"David asked on the basis of God's name and mercy, not on the basis of his own righteousness." [1]

David did not make his own good record the condition. His reason for asking God's help was "Because Your mercy is good." Coming before God rests on the love He already has, without having to first prove you are good enough.

Topic 2: God Stands on the Side of the Oppressed

"At the right hand of the tormentor stands Satan as an accuser, at the right hand of the tormented one stands God as his vindicator." [2]

Earlier, an accuser stood at the wicked man's right hand; here God stands at the right hand of the poor to back him up. God chooses to stand beside the weak and the pushed-down as their defender.

IV. Reflection Question

When you feel like a failure and people look down on you, how do you assume God sees you? The end of Psalm 109 says God "stands at the right hand of the poor" — He is on the side of the weak and the mistreated.

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik Commentary on Psalm 109,
<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/psalm-109/>

[2] BibleHub.com, Keil & Delitzsch (Psalm 109:31),
<https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/psalms/109-31.htm>